In second class carriages, it appears to be sufficient to have venetians without glass, excepting in the upper panel of the doors, where it would be better to have both glass and venetians, and the purdahs could in this case be dispensed with, excepting over the door.

As the third class carriages will be used only by natives regardless of the heat, the above precautions may be dispensed with, and a carriage having a simple roof supported by iron standards, and protected in some measure by strong leather, or cloth curtains, will be sufficient.

It is probable that the best lining for the first class carriages will be cloth stuffed in the usual way; though whatever is adopted, great care must be taken to keep away insects.

Second class carriages might, with propriety, have rattan seats and backs, and third class wooden seats with a rail for the back.

Besides the provisions which is necessary to make against the heat of the climate, it is also necessary to provide in some measure for the peculiarities of Native society.

It is certainly neither the interest, nor the duty of the Railway Company, to recognize in any way the distinctions of creed and caste, so as to provide one carriage for a Brahmin, and another for a Pariah, and the only distinction made should be that which can be purchased by money.

At the same time, there should be every reasonable provision made to enable natives to be as private as they please.

I refer especially to the case of women, and to enable a man to travel with his wife privately without inconvenience to the public or loss to the Railway Company. I should recommend that many of the first and second class carriages should be made with a coupe at each end.

Then in the case of females travelling alone, it would be easy to assign one particular carriage in a train for women exclusively, when required.

In the above remarks, I have assumed that it will be best to adopt three classes of carriages, as I believe that the interests of the company, and the requirements of the public, will be best answered by such an arrangement.

The plan, originally proposed, of sending out all the iron work (in the first instance at least) from England, and working drawings of the carriages, so that they may be made up in this country, appears to be the best arrangement which could be adopted.

—George B. Bruce
Chief Engineer

As if the details and elaborations were not enough, the consulting engineer wrote back suggesting a fourth class, the cheapest of them all, for the masses, with the goods train.

Observation by the Consulting Engineer

…I consider that arrangements will have to be made, hereafter, for providing the cheapest possible means of transport for a fourth class of passenger with the goods train. Carriage trucks, mail vans and other special conveyances will have to be constructed hereafter. The whole of the upper works might, with advantage, be made in this country, from the commencement; and I doubt not that men of enterprise and ability will be found in Madras to make, after a little observation, the entire carriages. [59]

—T.T. Pears
Consulting Engineer for Railways